Visionary Grants Applicant Guidelines

What This Grant Supports

Visionary Grants support community-driven ideas that emerge from lived experience and community voice AND/OR projects that are testing new approaches, piloting emerging ideas, or exploring creative solutions. Visionary Grants funds projects that are early stage, experimental, or not yet ready for traditional funding. Their purpose is to support the kinds of ideas that often struggle to find investment: ideas that are bold, community rooted, creative, or exploratory, and that have the potential to spark learning, strengthen community connections, or offer insight into systems and root causes.

Section	Question(s)	Guidance
Organization Information	Year established Mission, Vision, Values Fiscal sponsorship Organization service area	This section gives reviewers a basic picture of your organization. Reviewers are not scoring you on size or age – they want to understand what drives your organization and who you serve. If you use a fiscal sponsor, confirm your paperwork is complete before applying. To start that process, you may contact grants@cffoxvalley.org.
Request Information	1. Project name 2. Project description 3. Project start date 4. Project timeline	Reviewers will look for: • The high-level details of your project. They want to know what you want to do, who will benefit, and the basic timing of the project.
Project Summary	1. Project summary 2. Stage of Project 3. What experiences, relationships, or preparation support your ability to carry out this work? 4. Request focus area (branching question)	Reviewers will look for: • Applicants to expand on the project description and share high-level additional details. This section does not need to be long – it is more important to provide an overview of the project that helps reviewers understand what the

	a. Option 1: Community-driven idea shaped by lived experience or community voice i. If selecting option 1, following question is: *How did this idea emerge from lived experience, community voice, or grassroots leadership?* b. Option 2: Effort that is testing new approaches, piloting emerging ideas, and/or exploring creative solutions i. If selecting option 2, following question is: *What new approach, idea, or experiment does this project explore, and how might it benefit or strengthen the community?*	project/program/activity is aiming to achieve (the why and how). • An understanding of what stage of development the project is in, as this helps continue to frame up the project summary and details for more complete understanding. There is no "right or wrong" stage. • An understanding of whose experiences the project might be drawing from and/or the partnerships/collaborations at play to implement the project. Reviewers will choose one of two lenses based on which focus area you select: • If selecting Option 1: Reviewers will look for how clearly the idea emerges from lived experience or community insight and how it might benefit or strengthen the community. • If selecting Option 2: Reviewers will look for fresh approaches, a spirit of innovation, and the potential of the project to spark new thinking. What do you hope to learn and how will the work strengthen the community?
Funding Request & Budget	1. Total project budget 2. Amount requested	Reviewers will look for:

	3. Optional additional amount requested information: *In the event that we cannot fully fund your request, what amount would allow you to meaningfully begin your project? What changes in activities or outcomes would be affected?* 4. Project Budget Upload & Narrative	• A clear, realistic project budget that aligns with the scope of work. • Alignment between your activities and your costs • If full funding isn't possible, what amount of funding would help meaningfully start the work? What would the impact of partial funding be on the proposed activities? • A clear, practical description of how grant funds will be used